

Operations Console Design System

A complete, framework-agnostic specification of the visual language, layout system, component library and page blueprints required to reproduce the console interface from first principles.



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How to use this document

Sections 2 and 3 are normative: if you implement the tokens and the shell geometry exactly, everything else falls into place, because every component in section 4 is assembled from those same values. Section 4 gives per-component anatomy with measured dimensions and a rendered specimen. Section 5 composes the components into the five page archetypes that make up the entire product surface. Section 9 is the list you check your build against.

Neutrality note. All example labels, identifiers, entity names and figures in this document are placeholders. The specification describes structure, geometry and behaviour only; substitute your own domain vocabulary wherever a label appears.

1 Overview

1.1 What this system is

The console is a **dense, read-heavy administrative interface** for operators who manage large collections of records across many functional domains. A single deployment exposes on the order of a dozen functional groups and fifty-plus screens, yet the interface uses only **five page archetypes** and about twenty components. That ratio is the whole design: the system scales by repeating a small kit, not by inventing new surfaces per feature.

1.2 Who it serves

- **Operators** who live in list views: scanning, filtering, sorting, exporting. They need density, stable column positions, and fast scanning more than they need decoration.
- **Administrators** configuring entities through long forms. They need unambiguous field labels, inline validation, and a commit action that is always reachable.
- **Analysts** reading the dashboard. They need a small number of trustworthy numbers, not a wall of widgets.

1.3 Design principles

Five principles generate every decision in this document. When a new screen is designed, it should be derivable from these rather than from precedent.

Principle	What it means in practice
One accent, no palette	Exactly one saturated color exists — a deep indigo. It marks everything actionable or selected, and nothing else. There is no secondary brand color, no success green, no informational blue. Semantic color is restricted to a single red used only for validation failure. Everything else is a neutral. This is why the interface reads as calm at high density: color is a signal, not a texture.
Surface separates, not borders	Structure comes from white cards floating on an off-white canvas with a one-pixel shadow. Cards are not outlined. Inside a card, separation comes from a single hairline rule. The interface has essentially two elevations and one rule weight.
The shell never moves	A fixed 48 px bar and a 240 px navigation rail are present on every screen, in the same place, at the same size. Only the content region changes. Navigation state, environment context and the global refresh are always in the same three positions.
Density with rhythm	Everything sits on a 4 px base unit with an 8 px gutter; rows are 52 px; nav items are 36 px. Compact, but never arbitrary. Whitespace is spent on vertical rhythm inside rows, not on padding between cards.
Actions live at the edges	Record actions sit in a right-aligned toolbar above the data. Form commits sit in a bar pinned to the bottom of the content region. Destructive or global actions never float in the middle of content. An operator always knows the two places to look.

1.4 Non-goals

- **No dark theme.** The system is specified light-only. Every token below assumes a light canvas; a dark theme would require a second, separately validated token set.
- **No marketing surface.** There are no hero sections, illustrations, gradients or photography. The single illustrative asset in the system is the grey empty-state glyph.
- **Not mobile-first.** The shell is designed for a 1280 px-and-wider viewport. Below that it degrades gracefully (\$3.5) but data tables remain horizontally scrollable rather than restructured.

Reading the specimens. Every component in §4 is accompanied by a specimen rendered at 1:1 using the tokens in this document. If your implementation is correct, a screenshot of your component laid over the specimen should match within two pixels.

2 Foundations

2.1 Color

Twelve values. That is the entire palette, including semantics and disabled states. Resist adding to it; almost every request for a new color is better answered with weight, position or spacing.

Core tokens

Token	Value	Swatch	Role
primary	#091A82		The single accent. Primary buttons, active nav item and its 3 px indicator, all toolbar action labels and icons, in-cell links, selected tab label and its underline, chart series fill, tooltip value, focused field label and underline.
primary-hover	#2C3B93		Hover/pressed state for primary fills. Also the resting label color of a selected tab, which sits fractionally lighter than its indicator.
primary-wash	#EAECF5		8 % tint of the accent. Selected table rows, hovered menu items, chart hover band on white.
canvas	#FAFAFB		The page ground and the navigation rail — they are the same color, which is why the rail needs no divider against the content region.
surface	#FFFFFF		Cards, panels, tables, the top bar, menus, tooltips. The only elevated color.
divider	#E0E0E0		Every hairline in the system: table row rules, tab strip base, form footer top edge. Also the fill of the form commit bar.
input-line	#949494		Resting underline of a text field only. Deliberately darker than <code>divider</code> so inputs read as interactive.
text-primary	#212121		Headings, panel titles, statistic values, table cell content, entered field values.
text-secondary	#666666		Statistic captions, field labels, helper text, axis ticks, pagination, all metadata.
text-nav	#5D5D5D		Unselected navigation labels and their icons. One step darker than <code>text-secondary</code> because it sits on the canvas, not on white.
text-muted	#9B9B9C		Empty-state glyph, heading and body. Placeholder text. Never used for content the user must read.
error	#C74C42		The only semantic color. Validation messages, the field underline in an error state, required-field markers. Never used for anything merely "important".

Derived / state values

State	Value		Notes
Disabled control fill	#C5C5C5		Equivalent to <code>rgba(0, 0, 0, .12)</code> over the commit bar.
Disabled control label	#929292		<code>rgba(0, 0, 0, .26)</code> . Contrast against its own fill is 1.8:1 — see §8.4.
Row hover	<code>rgba(0, 0, 0, .04)</code>		Applies to table rows and navigation items.
Chart hover band	#CCCCCC		Full-height column highlight behind the hovered bar.
Chart gridline	#CCCCCC		Dashed, 1 px, horizontal only.

User-assigned colors

One class of color falls outside the palette: colors a user picks to label their own records (map overlays, category swatches). These are arbitrary and saturated — for example  #4C86F7,  #94FC5B,  #FEF860,  #63BFFA. Treat them as *data, not design*: render them only inside a 16 px square swatch with a `rgba(0, 0, 0, .15)` hairline, or as a map fill at 30 % opacity with the same hue at 100 % for the stroke. Never let a user color drive text, background or chrome, and never rely on it alone to convey meaning — always pair it with the record's name.

Color rules

- The accent is **never** used as a background for large regions. Its only fills are buttons, the 3 px nav indicator, the 2 px tab indicator and chart bars.
- Hover and selection are expressed with neutral or washed backgrounds, never by changing text color — except for the nav item, where selection changes both.
- There is no success state color. A completed action is communicated by the resulting content, not by a green anything.

2.2 Typography

One family, seven sizes, two weights. The family is a neutral grotesque — the reference implementation uses Roboto with a fallback chain of Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif. Any metric-compatible grotesque (Inter, Helvetica Neue, Liberation Sans) reproduces the design acceptably; a humanist or geometric face does not, because the system depends on tight apertures at 12–14 px.

```
font-family: Roboto, "Helvetica Neue", Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif;
```

Style	Size	Weight	Line height	Tracking	Applied to
Display	40 px	400	1.1	0	Statistic tile values only. Never used elsewhere.
Empty heading	28 px	400	1.2	0	The single line of an empty state.
Title	20 px	400	1.4	0.15 px	Page title in the top bar; panel/card titles; form section headline.
Body L	16 px	400	1.5	0.15 px	Navigation labels; entered field values; empty-state body; form group headings (at weight 500).
Body	14 px	400	1.43	0.17 px	All table content, column headers (weight 500), statistic captions, axis ticks, pagination, tooltips.
Action	13–14 px	500–600	1.75	0.06 em	All button and toolbar labels and tab labels. Always <code>text-transform: uppercase</code> .
Caption	12 px	400	1.5	0.03 em	Floating field labels, helper text, validation messages.

Typographic rules

- **Never bold for emphasis in data.** Table cells are all one weight. Hierarchy in a row comes from column order and color, not weight.
- **Uppercase is reserved for actions.** If text is uppercase, it must be clickable — a button, a toolbar action, or a tab. Nothing else in the interface is uppercased.
- **Titles are not bold.** The 20 px title sits at weight 400. Size alone carries it.
- **No italics anywhere** except the wordmark, which is a fixed asset.
- Numerals are proportional, but any column of quantities is right-aligned so the decimal positions still stack (§4.7).

1,284

No records yet.

Panel title

Navigation label / field value

Table cell content · 14 px body

ACTION LABEL

Caption, helper text and floating labels

2.3 Spacing & the grid

The base unit is **4 px**. The grid gutter is **8 px** — unusually tight, and it is the single most identifiable trait of this layout. Cards nearly touch; the 8 px channel plus the card shadow is all that separates them.

Token	Value	Used for
space-1	4 px	Icon-to-label inside dense rows; helper-text offset.
space-2	8 px	The grid gutter. Column and row gaps between all cards; content region padding.
space-3	12 px	Table cell horizontal padding; icon-to-label in toolbars.
space-4	16 px	Card interior padding (default); nav item horizontal padding; content region top offset.
space-5	24 px	Form card interior padding; form column gap; spacing between toolbar actions.
space-6	32 px	Vertical gap between form groups; empty-state block spacing.
space-8	48 px	Empty-state top offset; tall separations inside a single card.

The 12-column content grid

The content region is a 12-column grid with an 8 px gutter and no outer margin beyond the region's own 8 px padding. At the reference viewport (1488 px wide, 1237 px content region) this yields the following measured card widths:

Arrangement	Span each	Measured width	Where it appears
Four across	3 cols	303 px	Statistic tile row.
Two across	6 cols	615 px	Chart panel + ranked-table panel; the two-column form.
Full width	12 cols	1237 px	Data tables, maps, form cards.

Derivation: $(1237 - 3 \times 8) \div 4 = 303.25$ | $(1237 - 8) \div 2 = 614.5$

2.4 Elevation, shape & borders

Level	Shadow	Applied to
0 — ground	none	Canvas, navigation rail.

1 — card	0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0, .16)	Every card and panel, the tooltip. A barely-there lift; from a distance cards look like plain white rectangles.
2 — bar	0 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0, .14)	The fixed top bar only. It is the only element that casts a visible shadow onto content, which is how it reads as above the scroll.
3 — overlay	0 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0, .20)	Dropdown menus, date pickers, any transient surface.

Shape token	Value	Applied to
radius-sm	2 px	Color swatches, checkboxes.
radius-md	4 px	The default. Cards, panels, buttons, menus, tooltips.
radius-pill	16 px	Filter chips only.
border-hairline	1 px solid #E0E0E0	Every rule in the system.
indicator-nav	3 px solid #091A82	Active navigation item, left edge, full row height.
indicator-tab	2 px solid #091A82	Selected tab, bottom edge, tab width.

2.5 Iconography

- **Style:** outlined, 2 px stroke, rounded joins, drawn on a 24 px artboard with a 2 px optical margin. A single filled icon in a screen breaks the set.
- **Sizes:** 20 px in the navigation rail and the top bar; 18 px in toolbars beside an uppercase label; 16 px inside table rows; 84 px for the empty-state glyph (which is a solid silhouette, the one deliberate exception).
- **Color:** icons inherit their label's color exactly — `text-nav` in the rail, `primary` in toolbars and when a nav item is active, `text-secondary` in metadata positions.
- **Pairing:** a toolbar icon always precedes its label with a 6 px gap. Icons never appear alone in a toolbar; icon-only buttons exist solely in the top bar and in table row affordances, and each carries a tooltip.
- **Semantic reuse:** one glyph, one meaning, product-wide. The chevron means "expand" everywhere: pointing down when collapsed, up when expanded, right at the start of an expandable table row.

2.6 Motion

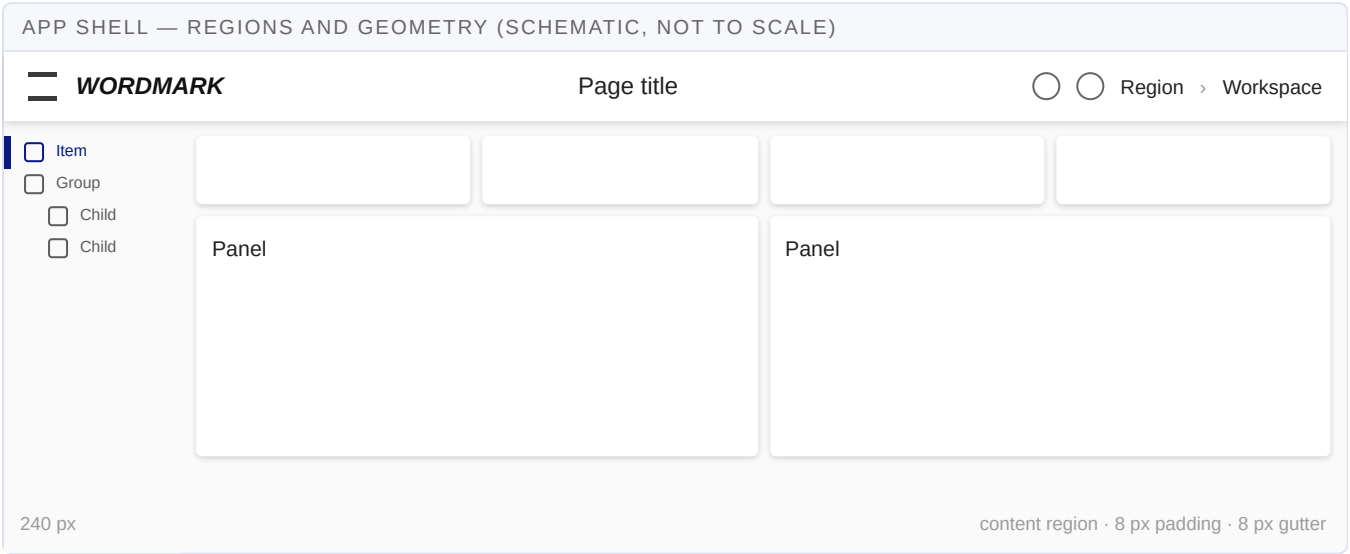
Transition	Duration	Easing	Notes
Hover / focus color	150 ms	ease-out	Background and color only.
Navigation group expand	200 ms	cubic-bezier(.4,0,.2,1)	Height auto-transition; chevron rotates over the same curve.
Field label float	200 ms	cubic-bezier(.0,0,.2,1)	Scale and translate together; never fade.
Tab indicator slide	250 ms	cubic-bezier(.4,0,.2,1)	The underline travels; it does not fade in and out.
Menu / overlay	200 ms in / 150 ms out	ease-out	Opacity plus 4 px rise.

Nothing else animates. Table rows, cards and page transitions are instantaneous — an operator paging through thousands of records must never wait on a transition. Respect `prefers-reduced-motion` by reducing all of the above to 0 ms.

3 Layout

3.1 The app shell

Four regions, fixed relationship, on every screen without exception.



Region	Geometry	Behaviour
A — Top bar	height 48 px full width fixed	Sits above everything at elevation 2. Never scrolls. Contains, left to right: rail toggle, wordmark, centered page title, then a right cluster of global refresh, account glyph and the environment breadcrumb.
B — Navigation rail	width 240 px top 48 px → bottom fixed	Same color as the canvas, no right border. Scrolls independently when its content exceeds the viewport. Collapses to 0 (off-canvas) via the toggle; content region then expands to full width.
C — Content region	left 240 px → right edge padding 8 px top offset 16 px	The only scrolling region. Hosts one 12-column grid. Measured content width at the reference viewport: 1237 px.
D — Commit bar	height 56 px width of content region sticky bottom	Present on form pages only. Pinned to the bottom of the content region, full card width, 1 px top divider, #E0E0E0 fill.

Exact vertical stack (reference viewport)

y = 0	top bar begins	height 48 px, elevation 2
y = 48	content region begins	background #FAFAFB
y = 64	first card's top edge	(16 px top offset)
y = 144	statistic row ends	(80 px tile height)
y = 152	second row begins	(8 px gutter)

Exact horizontal stack (reference viewport, 1488 px)

x = 0	navigation rail	width 240 px
x = 240	content region begins	
x = 244	first card's left edge	(8 px padding, less shadow bleed)
x = 1481	last card's right edge	

3.2 Page title placement

The page title lives in the **center of the top bar**, not above the content. This is unusual and deliberate: it frees the entire content region for data, and it keeps the title visible while the content scrolls. Consequences you must honour:

- The dashboard has **no** title — the statistic tiles are self-describing.
- Because the title is centered in the full bar width, it can visually collide with a long environment breadcrumb. Truncate the breadcrumb with an ellipsis before you truncate the title.
- Sub-page titles use the same slot: a create screen shows a verb phrase such as "Create record", while the card beneath repeats it as a 20 px section headline. The duplication is intentional — the bar title is for orientation while scrolled, the card headline for the form's own structure.

3.3 Navigation rail structure

- **Two levels only.** A flat item (the dashboard) or a group with children. Never three.
- **Groups are accordions**, and **multiple groups may be open at once** — the rail is a persistent map, not a single-path selector. Expansion state persists across navigation.
- **Every item has an icon**, parents and children alike, at 20 px. Child icons are indented 16 px past the parent's icon, so the icon column itself communicates depth.
- **An external link** (documentation, another product) carries a trailing "open in new" glyph and is otherwise styled as a normal child.
- A group's parent row is **not** itself a destination. Clicking it only expands or collapses.
- The rail scrolls; the shell does not. With ten or more groups expanded the rail will exceed the viewport, which is expected and acceptable.

3.4 Environment context

The top-right breadcrumb (`Region > Workspace`) is a two-level scope indicator preceded by an account glyph. It is the mechanism by which an operator knows which data set they are looking at, and it must be present on every screen, including modals and error pages. Treat it as a safety device, not decoration: when the scope is non-production it should be visually distinguishable — the recommended treatment is the label itself, not a colored banner, so the palette stays intact.

3.5 Responsive behaviour

Breakpoint	Rail	Content
≥ 1440 px reference	Expanded, 240 px	Four statistic tiles across; two panels across; tables show all columns.
1280 – 1439 px	Expanded, 240 px	Unchanged; cards simply narrow. Tables begin to scroll horizontally.
960 – 1279 px	Collapsed by default, opened as an overlay	Statistic tiles wrap to 2 × 2; panels stack to one column; form drops to a single column.
< 960 px	Off-canvas overlay with scrim	Everything single column. Tables scroll horizontally inside their card; the first column may be pinned. Toolbar actions collapse into an overflow menu, keeping only the primary create action visible. The commit bar remains sticky and full width.

What does not change. The top bar stays 48 px at every width, row height stays 52 px, and the gutter stays 8 px. Density is a product decision here, not a screen-size decision.

4 Components

Twenty primitives. Each entry gives anatomy, measured geometry, and states. Specimens are rendered at 1:1 from the tokens in §2.

4.1 Top bar

SPECIMEN — TOP BAR, 48 PX

≡

wordmark

Records

○

○

Region > Workspace

Property	Value
Height	48 px
Background / elevation	#FFFFFF · 0 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0,.14)
Horizontal padding	16 px
Left cluster	Rail toggle (20 px glyph) → 16 px gap → wordmark (height ≈ 20 px, italic, near-black)
Center	Page title, 20 px / 400 / #212121 , absolutely centered in the bar
Right cluster	Refresh (20 px) → 12 px → account glyph (20 px) → 8 px → breadcrumb, 14 px / #212121 , separator > in #9B9B9C
Icon buttons	40 px hit target, circular ripple, rgba(0,0,0,.04) hover

4.2 Navigation item

SPECIMEN — RAIL ITEMS: ACTIVE, COLLAPSED GROUP, EXPANDED GROUP WITH CHILDREN, HOVER

Dashboard

Group A

▼

Group B

^

Child one

Child two

Group C

▼

Property	Value
Row height	36 px
Horizontal padding	16 px
Child indent	+16 px
Icon	20 px
Icon → label gap	14 px

Label	16 px / 400 / #5D5D5D
Chevron	18 px, right-aligned, #5D5D5D
Active	Label and icon → #091A82 ; 3 px full-height left indicator in #091A82 ; background unchanged
Hover	rgba(0,0,0,.04) background, no color change
Focus-visible	2 px #091A82 outline, 2 px offset, inside the rail

Only one active item exists at a time, and it is always a leaf. When a child is active, its parent group stays expanded but the parent row receives no active styling.

4.3 Card / panel

The universal container. Everything in the content region is inside one.

Property	Value
Background	#FFFFFF
Radius	4 px
Shadow	0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,.16)
Border	None. Never outline a card.
Padding	16 px
Padding (form cards)	24 px
Padding (tables)	0 – the table bleeds to the card edge; only cells are padded.
Title	20 px / 400 / #212121 , sits at the padding edge, 16 px above content
Header control	An optional right-aligned select on the title line (for example a period filter), baseline-aligned with the title

4.4 Statistic tile



Property	Value
Height	80 px (fixed)
Content	Two lines, both horizontally and vertically centered
Value	40 px / 400 / #212121
Caption	14 px / 400 / #666666 , 2-4 px below the value
Units	Rendered inline with the value at the same size — 92.5 GB , not a superscript or a separate line. One space between number and unit.

Zero	Rendered as <code>0</code> , never as "—" or "None"
Loading	Skeleton: two centered grey bars (96 × 28 px and 72 × 12 px) at <code>rgba(0, 0, 0, .06)</code>

Rules. Four tiles maximum in a row. No icons, no trend arrows, no sparklines, no percentage deltas — a tile is a single number and its name. If a metric needs context, it belongs in the chart panel, not the tile.

4.5 Action toolbar

SPECIMEN — RIGHT-ALIGNED TOOLBAR ABOVE A DATA TABLE

IMPORTEXPORTCOLUMNSCREATEADD FILTER

Property	Value
Position	Above the data card, right-aligned, on the canvas — not inside the card
Height / padding	36 px · 8 px above and below
Gap between actions	24 px
Label	13 px / 500 / uppercase / 0.06 em / #091A82
Icon	18 px, #091A82, 6 px before the label
Background	None at rest; <code>rgba(9, 26, 130, .06)</code> on hover with 4 px radius
Order	Left to right, least to most consequential, ending with the filter control: Import · Export · Columns · Create · Add filter. Keep this order product-wide.

All toolbar actions are text buttons — there is no filled button in a list toolbar. The only filled buttons in the system are the empty-state create action and a form's commit button.

4.6 Data table

The most important component in the system — most operator time is spent here.

SPECIMEN — DATA TABLE: HEADER, EXPANDABLE ROWS, SELECTION, LINK CELL, BOOLEAN CELL						
	☐	Name	Identifier	Group	Flag	Created ↓
>	☐	Record name A	00000000000001	Default		03/09/2026 09:18:19
>	☐	Record name B	00000000000002	Default	×	02/09/2026 08:51:30
>	☒	Record name C	00000000000003	Default		01/09/2026 13:32:29

Property	Value
Header row height	56 px
Body row height	52 px
Cell padding	0 12px
Row rule	1 px solid #E0E0E0 (bottom of every row, including the header)
Header type	14 px / 500 / #212121
Cell type	14 px / 400 / #212121
Link cell	14 px / 400 / #091A82 , no underline at rest, underline on hover
Sorted column	Arrow glyph (↓ descending, ↑ ascending) after the label, 16 px, #666666 ; the label itself does not change color or weight
Sortable, unsorted	Arrow appears at 40 % opacity on header hover only
Row hover	rgba(0,0,0,.04)
Row selected	#EAECF5 , checkbox filled with #091A82
Expand affordance	Right-pointing chevron in a 34 px leading column; rotates 90° down when open and reveals a detail panel spanning all columns
Select column	38 px wide, 18 px checkbox, header checkbox toggles the page (not the whole result set — state that explicitly in the UI when they differ)

Column rules

- **Order:** expand → select → primary label → identifiers → relationships → booleans → timestamps. Timestamps last, right-aligned; quantities right-aligned; everything else left-aligned.
- **Two-line headers are allowed** and are why the header row is 56 px rather than 52. Never truncate a header — wrap it.
- **Empty cells stay empty.** No "—", no "N/A", no grey placeholder. Absence of data is information, and dashes at this density create visual noise that reads as content.
- **Booleans** render as a single 16 px glyph (a cross or a check) or nothing at all; never as the words "true"/"false".

- **Long opaque identifiers** are shown in full and allowed to wrap to two lines rather than truncated, because a partial identifier is useless. Give these columns a generous fixed width.
- **Timestamps** wrap to two lines: date on the first, time in #666666 on the second.

4.7 Pagination

Property	Value
Position	Inside the table card, right-aligned, below the last row
Height	52 px
Content	Rows per page: 20 ▾ · 24 px gap · 1-18 of 18 · previous / next chevrons
Type	14 px / 400 / #666666
Page size options	10 · 20 · 50 · 100, default 20
Disabled arrows	rgba(0,0,0,.26) , not hidden

4.8 Tabs

SPECIMEN — VIEW TABS INSIDE A CARD		
LIST	MAP	

Property	Value
Position	Top of the card, left-aligned, flush with the card's left edge
Height	48 px
Tab padding	0 16px , minimum width 90 px
Label	14 px / 500 / uppercase / 0.06 em
Resting color	#666666
Selected color	#2C3B93 with a 2 px #091A82 bottom indicator
Base rule	1 px solid #E0E0E0 across the full card width

Tabs switch *representation*, never scope: the same records shown as a list or on a map. If the underlying record set would change, use navigation, not tabs.

4.9 Text field

SPECIMEN — FIELD STATES: EMPTY, FILLED, FOCUSED, ERROR, DISABLED

Label

Helper text explains the format

Label

Entered value

Helper text explains the format

Label

Entered value

Helper text explains the format

Label

Bad value

Must match the required format

Property	Value
Style	Underline only — no box, no fill, no outline
Field height	48 px (label + value + underline), helper text sits below
Resting underline	1 px #949494
Hover underline	1 px #212121
Focused underline	2 px #091A82 , grows from the center over 200 ms
Error underline	2 px #C74C42
Disabled underline	1 px dotted #E0E0E0
Label (empty)	16 px / #666666 , sitting on the value baseline
Label (floated)	12 px / #666666 , 20 px above the baseline; #091A82 while focused, #C74C42 in error
Value	16 px / 400 / #212121
Helper / error text	12 px , 4 px below the underline, #666666 or #C74C42
Required	A trailing  appended to the label. No color, no other marker.

Helper text is not optional decoration. Any field with a format constraint states that constraint in helper text at rest — before the user can get it wrong — and the error message on failure restates the same rule in the same words.

4.10 Select, date field and other inputs

Every input in the system wears the text field's clothes: same height, same underline, same floating label, same helper slot. Only the trailing affordance differs.

Input	Trailing affordance	Notes
Select	Down chevron, 20 px, #666666 , right-aligned	Menu opens at elevation 3, matches field width, 36 px options, selected option in #EAECF5 . A select is never rendered as a native control.
Date	Calendar glyph, 20 px	Value displayed as YYYY-MM-DD in a form; picker at elevation 3.
Read-only / computed	None	Same typography, underline omitted entirely, label always floated, helper text states the derivation — e.g. "Automatically calculated". Never disable a computed field; render it as static text with a label.
Reference / lookup	Down chevron	Behaves as a select but loads asynchronously; shows a 2 px indeterminate bar on the underline while loading.
Checkbox	—	18 px box, 2 px #757575 border, fill #091A82 when checked, 4 px gap to a 14 px label.

4.11 Buttons

SPECIMEN — CONTAINED (PRIMARY), TEXT, AND DISABLED

CREATE

CANCEL

SAVE

Variant	Spec	Where
Contained	Height 36 px · padding 0 16 px · radius 4 px · fill #091A82 · label 14 px / 500 / uppercase / 0.06 em / white · shadow 0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,.25) Hover #2C3B93 ; active shadow removed.	Exactly two places: the empty-state create action, and a form's commit button.
Text	Height 36 px · padding 0 8 px · no fill · label as above in #091A82 · hover rgba(9,26,130,.06)	Toolbars, dialog secondary actions, inline row actions.
Disabled	Fill #C5C5C5 , label #929292 , no shadow, cursor not-allowed	Commit buttons before a form is valid.
Icon button	40 px circular hit area, 20 px glyph, hover rgba(0,0,0,.04)	Top bar only, plus table row affordances.

Leading icons are 18 px with a 8 px gap. There are no outlined buttons, no rounded/pill buttons, no destructive-red buttons — a destructive action is a text button that opens a confirmation dialog.

4.12 Commit bar

SAVE

SAVE

Property	Value
Position	Sticky to the bottom of the content region, spanning the form card's full width
Height	56 px
Fill	#E0E0E0
Top edge	1 px solid #E0E0E0 against the white card above it
Padding	10 px 16 px
Button placement	Left-aligned , with a 18 px leading save glyph
Default state	Disabled until the form is valid and dirty

Left alignment is deliberate: the eye returns to the left margin after reading the last field, so the commit control is where the reading path ends. Secondary actions (Cancel, Delete) sit to the right of the primary button with a 16 px gap, as text buttons.

4.13 Empty state



No records yet.

Do you want to add one?

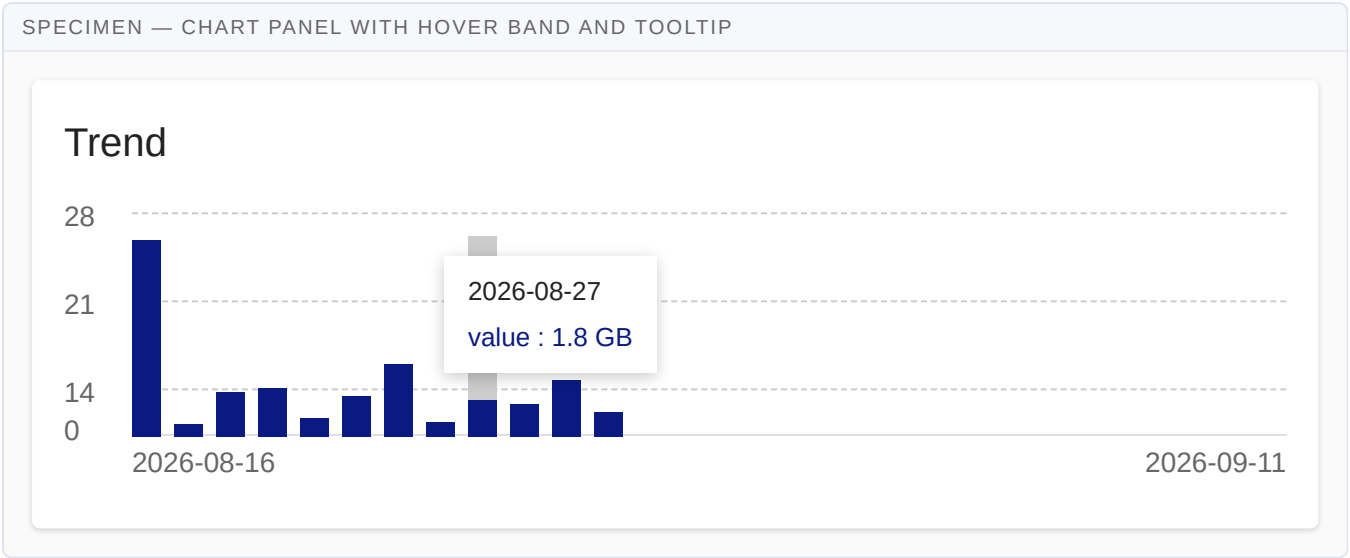
CREATE

Property	Value
Placement	Centered in the content region, ~120 px from the top; the card is not drawn
Glyph	84 × 66 px solid silhouette in #9B9B9C
Heading	28 px / 400 / #9B9B9C , one sentence with a full stop

Body	16 px / 400 / #9B9B9C , a question inviting the next step
Action	Contained primary button, 24 px below the body
Vertical rhythm	glyph → 16 px → heading → 8 px → body → 24 px → button

Three distinct empty states, and they must not share copy: *no data yet* (offer creation, as above); *no results for these filters* (offer to clear the filters; never show a create button here); *no permission* (state what is missing and who grants it, with no action button).

4.14 Bar chart panel



Property	Value
Chart type	Vertical bars, one per day, single series
Bar fill	#091A82 , no stroke, no radius
Bar width / gap	Bars occupy ~65 % of each band; gap is the remainder
Gridlines	1 px dashed #CCCCCC , horizontal only, 4-5 lines, drawn behind the bars
Axis ticks	14 px / #666666 ; y-axis labelled with unit suffix (0GB ... 28GB), x-axis with ISO dates every 5-6 bands
Axis lines	None on the y-axis; a single hairline baseline on the x-axis
Hover	Full-height band in #CCCCCC behind the hovered bar, snapping to the band, not the cursor
Tooltip	White, radius 4 px, elevation 1, padding 8 × 12 px; category on line one in #212121 , then value : 1.8 GB in #091A82
Legend	Omitted for a single series. Multi-series charts are out of scope for this palette — adding a second series requires a validated categorical ramp, which this system deliberately does not have.

4.15 Ranked list panel

A chart's companion: a table inside a panel, with a period selector on the title line.

- Title 20 px left; period select right-aligned on the same line, underline style, 14 px value.
- Two columns: identifier (left, 14 px) and quantity (right-aligned, 14 px, value + unit).
- Column headers present, 14 px / 500, with the standard hairline beneath.

- Rows 40 px — denser than the main data table, because this panel is for scanning, not acting.
- Seven to ten rows maximum; no pagination. If more are needed, link to the full list view.

4.16 Map view

Property	Value
Container	Inside the card, below the tab strip; 16 px inset on all sides; ~620 px tall
Base map	Muted light tiles — pale blue water, near-white land, no labels below country level. The base map must never out-contrast the overlays.
Overlay fill	User-assigned color at 30 % opacity
Overlay stroke	Same hue at 100 %, 2 px
Zoom control	Top-left, stacked + / –, 30 px square, white, radius 4 px, elevation 1
Attribution	Bottom-right, 11 px, #666666 — required, never suppressed
Pagination	The record count and page size still appear below the map, because the map is a <i>view of a page of records</i> , not of everything

4.17 Color swatch cell

16 px square, 2 px radius, `rgba(0,0,0,.15)` hairline, vertically centered in its cell, in a fixed ~56 px column placed immediately after the selection column. It is always adjacent to the record's name — the color alone never identifies a record.

4.18 Filter chip

Adding a filter inserts a chip row between the toolbar and the data card: pill, 32 px tall, #EAECF5 fill, 14 px label in #091A82 reading `Field: value`, with a 16 px dismiss glyph. Chips wrap; a "Clear all" text button follows the last chip. Filters are reflected in the URL so a filtered view is shareable.

4.19 Dialog

Elevation 3, radius 4 px, 24 px padding, max width 480 px, centered, scrim `rgba(0,0,0,.5)`. Title 20 px, body 14 px, actions right-aligned in a 16 px-tall footer band: secondary as a text button, primary as a contained button. Dialogs are used only for confirmation and for short single-purpose forms; anything longer is a page.

4.20 Loading & feedback

- **Table loading:** keep the header, render five skeleton rows of 52 px with a `rgba(0,0,0,.06)` bar per cell. Never a centered spinner over an empty card.
- **Global refresh:** the top-bar refresh glyph rotates 360° over 600 ms per fetch.
- **Save in flight:** the commit button keeps its label and adds a 16 px indeterminate ring; the button is disabled but not greyed.
- **Notifications:** a 48 px snack bar at the bottom-left of the content region, #212121 fill, white 14 px text, 4 s auto-dismiss, with an optional uppercase text action in #FFFFFF. Errors use the same bar with a #C74C42 fill and do not auto-dismiss.

5 Page blueprints

Every screen in the product is one of these five. If a new requirement does not fit, the correct response is almost always to decompose it into two screens that do.

5.1 Dashboard

```
Top bar:  no page title
Content:  [ tile ][ tile ][ tile ][ tile ]      4 × 303 px, 80 px tall, 8 px gutter
          [ chart panel ][ ranked panel ]      2 × 615 px, equal height, 8 px gutter
          (nothing below the fold)
```

- Exactly four tiles: a count, a change-since-a-reference-point, a total, and today's increment. The pair "total / today" gives scale and momentum in two glances.
- The chart's range and the ranked panel's period are controlled independently — the ranked panel carries its own selector, defaulting to "All time".
- No dashboard filters, no date-range picker in the top bar, no widget rearrangement. The dashboard is a fixed report, and its value comes from being identical every morning.
- The page ends after the second row. Resist the urge to fill the fold.

5.2 List

```
Top bar:  page title = plural entity name
Content:  [                               toolbar, right-aligned ]      36 px, on canvas
          [ card: table header 56 px                               ]
          [           rows 52 px ...                               ]
          [           pagination 52 px, right-aligned              ]
```

- The toolbar sits on the canvas above the card, never inside it.
- Default sort is the creation timestamp, descending — newest first — and the sorted column shows its arrow from first paint.
- Column visibility, filters, sort, page and page size are all reflected in the URL query string so a view can be shared or bookmarked.
- Row click opens the record; the leading chevron expands an inline detail panel without navigating. Both affordances must be present; they serve different tasks.

5.3 List with alternate view

```
Top bar:  page title
Content:  [                               toolbar, right-aligned ]
          [ card: tabs 48 px · LIST · MAP ·                               ]
          [           active view                                         ]
          [           pagination 52 px                                     ]
```

- The toolbar is shared by both views and does not change between them — the same create, filter and export actions apply.
- Pagination applies to both views; the map shows the current page only.
- The selected tab is held in the URL, so a link can open either view.

5.4 Create / edit form

```

Top bar:  page title = verb + entity ("Create record")
Content:  [ card, 24 px padding                                ]
          [ 20 px headline                                       ]
          [ field          | field          ] 2 cols, 24 px gap
          [ field          | field          ]
          [ 16 px group heading                                   ]
          [ field          | field          ]
          [ _____ ]
          [ commit bar 56 px, sticky, Save left-aligned         ]

```

- **Two columns, always**, above 960 px. Fields read left-to-right then down; pairs that belong together (start/end, issue/due) share a row.
- **Group headings** at 16 px / 500 separate logical sections with 32 px above and 16 px below. Groups are not cards, boxes or accordions — just a heading and rhythm.
- **Derived values render immediately**. A field computed from others (a due date from a term) updates as soon as its inputs change, is labelled as automatic in its helper text, and is never editable.
- **Defaults are pre-filled and visible**: today's date, the current period, the most common currency. An operator should be able to complete a routine record by filling only the genuinely record-specific fields.
- **Validation on blur, not on keystroke**. The commit button stays disabled until the form is both valid and dirty. On a failed submit, focus moves to the first invalid field and the page scrolls it to the vertical center.

5.5 Empty state page

```

Top bar:  page title (unchanged — the page exists even with no data)
Content:  centered glyph / heading / question / contained Create button
          no card, no toolbar, no table chrome

```

The toolbar is suppressed entirely so that the single create action is unambiguous. As soon as one record exists, the page becomes the standard list blueprint.

5.6 Information architecture pattern

The rail carries roughly a dozen top-level entries. The shape — not the vocabulary — is the reusable part:

1. A single flat **overview** item at the top, always first, always the default route.
2. Groups ordered by **frequency of use**, not alphabetically: the objects an operator touches daily first, configuration in the middle, commercial and administrative functions last.
3. Each group holds **two to seven children**. A group with one child should be a flat item; a group with more than seven needs splitting.
4. Within a group, the **primary entity comes first**, followed by its groupings, then its sub-resources, then its logs or sessions.
5. **Cross-cutting concerns** (access control, integrations, analytics) get their own groups rather than being duplicated inside every domain group.

6 Interaction & state model

One matrix governs every interactive element. Implement it once, centrally.

State	Treatment	Notes
Rest	As specified per component.	—
Hover	Background darkens by <code>rgba(0,0,0,.04)</code> ; accent-colored elements instead take <code>rgba(9,26,130,.06)</code> . Color and size never change.	150 ms ease-out. Links are the one exception: they gain an underline.
Focus-visible	2 px <code>#091A82</code> outline at 2 px offset, following the element's radius.	Keyboard only. Must never be removed; if a component's own focus treatment is subtle (a field underline), add the outline as well.
Active / pressed	Contained buttons lose their shadow; other elements deepen the hover background to <code>rgba(0,0,0,.08)</code> .	No scale or translate transforms.
Selected	Accent color for text and indicator; <code>#EAECF5</code> background for rows and menu options.	Selection must be visible without color alone — an indicator, a filled checkbox or a position change accompanies it.
Disabled	Fill <code>#C5C5C5</code> , label <code>#929292</code> , no shadow, no hover, <code>aria-disabled</code> set.	A disabled control must be explained: helper text or a tooltip states what would enable it.
Loading	Skeleton bars at <code>rgba(0,0,0,.06)</code> preserving final layout; indeterminate ring on in-flight buttons.	Never a full-page spinner; never a layout shift on resolve.
Error	<code>#C74C42</code> on the underline, the label and the message.	The message says what is wrong <i>and</i> what valid looks like.
Empty	Per §4.13, with copy matched to the cause.	Three distinct causes, three distinct messages.

6.1 Keyboard model

Key	Behaviour
Tab / Shift+Tab	Moves through rail → top bar → toolbar → table → pagination → commit bar, in visual order.
Enter / Space	Activates the focused control; on a table row, opens the record.
Arrow Up / Down	Moves between options in an open menu, and between rows in a focused table.
Escape	Closes a menu, dialog or expanded row, returning focus to its trigger.
Space (on a row)	Toggles that row's selection checkbox.

7 Content rules

Element	Rule	Example
Navigation labels	Plural noun, sentence case, no articles	Records · Record groups · Sessions
Page titles	Match the nav label exactly; forms prepend a verb	Records · Create record
Column headers	Sentence case, no colons, no units in the header when units vary by row	Name · Created at · Last activity
Buttons & toolbar	Uppercase verb, one word wherever possible	CREATE · EXPORT · SAVE · ADD FILTER
Field labels	Sentence case, trailing * if required, no colon	Reference number * · Payment terms *
Helper text	States the constraint, not the obvious; ends with no full stop	Must start with a two-letter prefix followed by 10 digits
Statistic captions	Two or three words, sentence case, no units	Total records · Added today
Empty state	Statement + question; never an apology, never an exclamation mark	No records yet. / Do you want to add one?

7.1 Data formatting

- **Dates in tables:** DD/MM/YYYY on line one, HH:MM:SS in #666666 on line two. Right-aligned.
- **Dates in forms and on axes:** ISO YYYY-MM-DD, unambiguous for input and sortable on an axis.
- **Quantities:** three significant figures with a scaled unit — 92.5 GB, 81.5 MB, 4.8 GB — never raw byte counts, never more precision than the reader can use. One space before the unit.
- **Counts:** integers with a thousands separator, no unit.
- **Opaque identifiers:** shown in full, in the body font (not monospace), allowed to wrap. A truncated identifier is worse than a wrapped one.
- **Enumerations:** sentence case in the UI even if the stored value is uppercase.
- **Nothing:** render as an empty cell. Not "—", not "N/A", not "null".

7.2 Voice

Neutral, terse, mechanical. No first person, no exclamation marks, no reassurance. The interface states what is, and what the operator can do next. Copy that would sound out of place in a technical reference manual does not belong here.

8 Accessibility

8.1 Measured contrast

Pair	Ratio	WCAG AA	Verdict
#212121 on #FFFFFF	16.1:1	Pass	Body and table text — ample headroom.
#212121 on #FAFAFB	15.4:1	Pass	Text on the canvas.
#091A82 on #FFFFFF	14.2:1	Pass	Accent on white, and white on accent — identical ratio.
#666666 on #FFFFFF	5.7:1	Pass	Secondary text, including at 12 px.
#5D5D5D on #FAFAFB	6.3:1	Pass	Navigation labels.
#9B9B9C on #FAFAFB	2.7:1	Fail	Empty-state text. See §8.4.
#929292 on #C5C5C5	1.8:1	Fail	Disabled button label. See §8.4.
#E0E0E0 on #FFFFFF	1.3:1	n/a	Decorative hairline; not a boundary users must perceive.

8.2 Semantics

- The rail is a `<nav>` containing a list; groups use `aria-expanded`; the active item carries `aria-current="page"`.
- Tables are real `<table>` elements with `<th scope="col">`; sortable headers expose `aria-sort`. Do not build a table from divs.
- Every icon-only control has an accessible name; decorative glyphs are `aria-hidden`.
- Fields use real `<label>` elements — the floating label is the label, not a placeholder. Helper and error text are linked via `aria-describedby`; invalid fields set `aria-invalid`.
- Validation summaries and snack bars announce through a polite live region; errors through an assertive one.
- The chart is `role="img"` with a summary label, and its data is reachable as a table — the ranked panel beside it serves that purpose on the dashboard.

8.3 Targets and motion

- Minimum interactive target 40 × 40 px. Note that 36 px nav rows and toolbar buttons rely on full-width or padded hit areas to reach this — verify, don't assume.
- Nothing depends on hover alone: the chart tooltip must also appear on keyboard focus of a bar.
- All transitions collapse to 0 ms under `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce`.

8.4 Known gaps, and how to close them

Two failures are inherited from the reference design. They are documented here rather than silently reproduced.

- Empty-state text at 2.7:1.** Fix by darkening empty-state heading and body to `#6E6E70` (4.6:1) while leaving the glyph at `#9B9B9C` — the drawing may stay light, the words may not.
- Disabled button label at 1.8:1.** Disabled controls are exempt from WCAG 1.4.3, but a commit button an operator cannot read is a usability failure regardless. Fix by darkening the label to `#6B6B6B` on the same fill (3.4:1) and always pairing the disabled state with a visible explanation of what is missing.

A third, milder issue: `#E0E0E0` hairlines are the sole separator between table rows at 1.3:1. For users with low vision, offer a density/contrast preference that swaps the rule to `#BDBDBD` and enables zebra striping at `rgba(0,0,0,.02)`.

9 Build checklist

A reproduction is faithful when every line below is true.

Foundations

- Exactly twelve palette values are defined, and no component introduces a thirteenth.
- The accent appears only on: primary buttons, the nav indicator and active nav item, toolbar labels and icons, in-cell links, the selected tab and its indicator, chart bars, tooltip values, focused field labels and underlines.
- Type is one family at seven sizes; uppercase appears only on interactive labels.
- Every measurement is a multiple of 4 px; the grid gutter is 8 px.

Shell

- Top bar is 48 px, fixed, white, with elevation 2 and a centered page title.
- Rail is 240 px, canvas-colored, borderless, with 36 px rows and 16 px child indent.
- The active nav item shows a 3 px left indicator and accent-colored label *and* icon.
- Multiple nav groups can be open simultaneously, and expansion survives navigation.
- The environment breadcrumb is present in the top-right on every screen.

Content

- Cards are white, 4 px radius, one-pixel shadow, no border.
- Statistic tiles are 80 px tall with a 40 px centered value and a 14 px caption; four per row.
- Table header rows are 56 px, body rows 52 px, cell padding 12 px, rules `#E0E0E0`.
- Toolbars are right-aligned, on the canvas above the card, text buttons only, 24 px apart.
- Pagination is inside the card, right-aligned, showing page size and a range-of-total.
- Empty cells are empty; timestamps wrap to two lines; quantities are right-aligned with scaled units.

Forms

- Inputs are underline-only with floating 12 px labels and a persistent helper slot.
- Two columns above 960 px, 24 px gap, 24 px card padding.
- Computed fields are non-editable static text with an explanatory helper line.
- The commit bar is sticky, 56 px, `#E0E0E0`, with a left-aligned primary button disabled until valid and dirty.

Behaviour

- Sort, filters, columns, page, page size and selected tab all live in the URL.
- Loading uses skeletons that preserve layout; nothing shifts on resolve.
- Focus-visible outlines are present on every interactive element.
- The three empty states have three different messages.
- The two contrast gaps in §8.4 are closed, not copied.

The one-sentence test. If you can describe any new screen you build as "a toolbar, a card, and rows" — or "a card, two columns of underlined fields, and a commit bar" — it belongs to this system. If you cannot, redesign it until you can.

Appendix A Design tokens

A.1 CSS custom properties

```
:root {  
  /* color */  
  --color-primary: #091A82;  
  --color-primary-hover: #2C3B93;  
  --color-primary-wash: #EAECF5;  
  --color-canvas: #FAFAFB;  
  --color-surface: #FFFFFF;  
  --color-divider: #E0E0E0;  
  --color-input-line: #949494;  
  --color-text-primary: #212121;  
  --color-text-secondary: #666666;  
  --color-text-nav: #5D5D5D;  
  --color-text-muted: #9B9B9C;  
  --color-error: #C74C42;  
  --color-disabled-bg: #C5C5C5;  
  --color-disabled-fg: #929292;  
  --overlay-hover: rgba(0,0,0,.04);  
  --overlay-hover-accent: rgba(9,26,130,.06);  
  --overlay-pressed: rgba(0,0,0,.08);  
  --overlay-skeleton: rgba(0,0,0,.06);  
  --scrim: rgba(0,0,0,.50);  
  
  /* typography */  
  --font-family: Roboto, "Helvetica Neue", Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif;  
  --font-display: 400 40px/1.10 var(--font-family);  
  --font-empty: 400 28px/1.20 var(--font-family);  
  --font-title: 400 20px/1.40 var(--font-family);  
  --font-body-lg: 400 16px/1.50 var(--font-family);  
  --font-body: 400 14px/1.43 var(--font-family);  
  --font-body-strong: 500 14px/1.43 var(--font-family);  
  --font-action: 500 13px/1.75 var(--font-family);  
  --font-caption: 400 12px/1.50 var(--font-family);  
  --tracking-action: .06em;  
  
  /* space */  
  --space-1: 4px; --space-2: 8px; --space-3: 12px; --space-4: 16px;  
  --space-5: 24px; --space-6: 32px; --space-8: 48px;  
  
  /* shape */  
  --radius-sm: 2px; --radius-md: 4px; --radius-pill: 16px;  
  --border-hairline: 1px solid var(--color-divider);  
  
  /* elevation */  
  --elev-1: 0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,.16);  
  --elev-2: 0 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0,.14);  
  --elev-3: 0 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0,.20);  
  
  /* layout */  
  --appbar-height: 48px;  
  --rail-width: 240px;  
  --content-pad: 8px;  
  --content-top: 16px;  
  --grid-gutter: 8px;  
  --row-height: 52px;  
  --row-header: 56px;  
  --row-nav: 36px;  
  --row-dense: 40px;  
  --tile-height: 80px;
```

```

--tab-height:      48px;
--commit-height:   56px;
--field-height:    48px;
--button-height:   36px;
--indicator-nav:   3px;
--indicator-tab:    2px;

/* motion */
--dur-fast:        150ms;
--dur-base:        200ms;
--dur-slow:        250ms;
--ease-standard:   cubic-bezier(.4,0,.2,1);
--ease-decelerate: cubic-bezier(0,0,.2,1);
}

```

A.2 JSON

```

{
  "color": {
    "primary": "#091A82", "primaryHover": "#2C3B93", "primaryWash": "#EAECF5",
    "canvas": "#FAFAFB", "surface": "#FFFFFF", "divider": "#E0E0E0",
    "inputLine": "#949494", "textPrimary": "#212121", "textSecondary": "#666666",
    "textNav": "#5D5D5D", "textMuted": "#9B9B9C", "error": "#C74C42",
    "disabledBg": "#C5C5C5", "disabledFg": "#929292"
  },
  "font": {
    "family": "Roboto, \"Helvetica Neue\", Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif",
    "size": { "display": 40, "empty": 28, "title": 20, "bodyLg": 16,
              "body": 14, "action": 13, "caption": 12 },
    "weight": { "regular": 400, "medium": 500, "semibold": 600 }
  },
  "space": { "1": 4, "2": 8, "3": 12, "4": 16, "5": 24, "6": 32, "8": 48 },
  "radius": { "sm": 2, "md": 4, "pill": 16 },
  "elevation": {
    "1": "0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,.16)",
    "2": "0 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0,.14)",
    "3": "0 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0,.20)"
  },
  "layout": {
    "appbarHeight": 48, "railWidth": 240, "contentPad": 8, "contentTop": 16,
    "gridGutter": 8, "rowHeight": 52, "rowHeader": 56, "rowNav": 36,
    "rowDense": 40, "tileHeight": 80, "tabHeight": 48, "commitHeight": 56,
    "fieldHeight": 48, "buttonHeight": 36, "indicatorNav": 3, "indicatorTab": 2
  },
  "motion": {
    "durations": { "fast": 150, "base": 200, "slow": 250 },
    "easing": { "standard": "cubic-bezier(.4,0,.2,1)",
                "decelerate": "cubic-bezier(0,0,.2,1)" }
  }
}

```

A.3 Quick reference — every fixed dimension

Element	px	Element	px
Top bar height	48	Table header row	56
Navigation rail width	240	Table body row	52
Navigation row height	36	Table cell padding (x)	12

Navigation child indent	16	Dense panel row	40
Content region padding	8	Tab strip height	48
Content top offset	16	Field height	48
Grid gutter	8	Form column gap	24
Statistic tile height	80	Button height	36
Card padding (default)	16	Commit bar height	56
Card padding (forms)	24	Toolbar action gap	24

A.4 Reference viewport

All measurements in this document were taken at a 1488 px logical viewport width (1 488 × 2 122 at 2× device pixel ratio), producing a 1237 px content region. Derived values – card widths, column spans – scale with the viewport; fixed values in A.3 do not.

Provenance. This specification was reconstructed by measuring rendered screenshots at 2× and normalising to CSS pixels. Color values are exact sampled pixel values. Dimensional values are accurate to ±2 px and have been rounded to the nearest 4 px grid step where the underlying intent was unambiguous. Typographic sizes were derived from measured cap heights assuming a 0.71 em cap ratio.